

Broker “Unknown Ticket” on the News Pre-Close Monitor

Incident report & fix documentation — TScopier signal copier

Severity	Major (recurring, non-retryable presentation)	Status	Fixed — fix pushed to dev & staging
Date detected	2026-08-21	Date fixed	2026-08-21
Affected users	Imran Uddin (basket #1757684700–4744), Ramandeep (#1398054)		
Component	News monitor (worker/src/newsTradingMonitor.ts)		
Root cause	Gone-position replies (“unknown ticket”) not reconciled; news monitor re-fires closes on every news event		

1. Executive summary (plain English)

The admin dashboard showed a stream of **Broker · Unknown ticket · Major** alerts. A customer (Imran Uddin) had a basket of 5 gold trades that had already been closed on the broker side, but our system still believed they were open. A background service called the **news monitor** — which closes positions automatically before economic news releases — kept trying to close those already-closed trades. The broker replied “*unknown ticket*” (meaning “I have no such open trade”), and because the monitor did not recognise that as “already closed,” it left the record open and **retried on every news event, over and over**.

The previous fix (Aug 10–11) had taught other monitors to handle gone-position replies, but the news monitor was missed. The fix brings the news monitor in line with the rest: when the broker says a position is already gone, we mark it closed and stop retrying.

2. Issue encountered

Repeated “**Broker · Unknown ticket · Major**” events, non-retryable. Each event showed a failed `order_close_audit` during a *close* stage. The same basket ticket numbers failed repeatedly across many news events.

Key symptom: one signal (`0cfaf2d5`) accumulated **89 failed** `order_close_audit` rows between 2026-08-12 and 2026-08-18, plus further batches on 08-20 (23:00) and 08-21 (05:30) for the same 5 tickets.

3. Affected user(s)

User	Ticket(s)	Symbol	Lot	Opened	DB status
Imran Uddin	#1757684700 / 4714 / 4719 / 4738 / 4744	XAUUSD+	0.01 each	2026-08-12	stuck <code>open</code>
Ramandeep	#1398054	XAUUSD.stand	0.3 (partial)	2026-08-21	single benign event

4. Root cause

The **news monitor** (`worker/src/newsTradingMonitor.ts`) runs every 60 seconds. For each broker it selects all trades where `status = 'open'` and, when a pre-news-close trigger fires, sends `orderClose(ticket)` for each. The production caller stack, captured in `trade_execution_logs.request_payload.stack`, proved the failing closes came from `NewsTradingMonitor.tick → FxsocketBrokerClient.orderClose`.

- Positions were closed on the broker side (take-profit / stop-loss / manual), so the broker replied “*unknown ticket*”.
- The monitor’s failure handler only logged a warning; it never detected gone-position errors, never marked the trade closed, and never reconciled.
- Because the database rows stayed `status = 'open'`, **every subsequent news event re-selected and re-closed the same dead tickets**, producing a failure per leg per event.
- The Aug 10–11 gone-position fix covered `partialTpMonitor`, `autoManagementMonitor`, `cweCloseMonitor`, `trailingStopMonitor`, `managementExecutor` and `forceCloseSignalTrades` — **the news monitor was the 7th site that was missed** (the “grep all six sites” lesson from our project memory).

5. The fix

`worker/src/newsTradingMonitor.ts` — the close failure handler now checks whether the broker reply means the position is already gone. If so, it:

- marks the trade `status = 'closed'` (with a concurrency guard so it cannot overwrite a row another worker already closed);
- stops re-selecting it on later news events.

Real failures (e.g. insufficient funds, network errors) are still logged as warnings and retried as before — only genuinely-gone positions are treated as resolved.

Design note: the gone-ticket handling lives in the caller (the news monitor), not in the shared broker client. Swallowing the error inside `fxsocketClient.orderClose` would have broken `PartialTpMonitor`, which depends on the error being raised to trigger its own leg-cancel bookkeeping.

6. Files changed

- `worker/src/newsTradingMonitor.ts` — added `reconcileGoneNewsTrade()` helper and gone-position handling in the close `catch` block.
- `worker/src/newsTradingMonitor.test.ts` — new regression tests (gone-ticket classification, reconcile behaviour, real failures stay non-benign).
- `docs/PROJECT_MEMORY.md` — incident changelog entry (deploy state, follow-ups).
- `docs/PROJECT_MEMORY-MARTINS.md` — relocated two Osodi-authored entries per contributor-memory policy.

7. Verification

- Worker build (`npm --prefix worker run build`): **pass**.
- Frontend typecheck: no new errors (only the pre-existing `src/lib/supabase.ts` debt).

- Targeted tests (news monitor + related monitors): **24/24 pass**.
- Code review: `code-tester` PASS; `code-review` PASS_WITH_NOTES (no blocking findings).

8. Deployment status

Pushed 2026-08-21 to all four branches:

- `upstream/dev` & `origin/dev` → `d6ab46b8`
- `upstream/staging` & `origin/staging` → `3b8e4f54`

Railway deploys from the `staging` branch. The fix must be confirmed live on staging, validated, then promoted to `main` /production. The 5 stale `open` rows for Imran's basket will reconcile automatically on the next news event once the fix is running.

9. Follow-ups

- Confirm the worker deploys from the updated staging branch and validate end-to-end.
- Promote to `main` /production after staging validation.
- Reporting layer: consider classifying gone-ticket closes as benign in the audit so the failure feed stays clean (do not swallow the error in the broker client).
- Consider a full `tick()` -level regression test (deferred: requires mocking calendar/blackout/broker dependencies).